

Code troubleshooting: One of the common problems faced by developers (and time consuming to address) is fixing code issues (compilation issue, performance issue, build issue). We can use Copilot to address the same. For example, I have used the prompt “Please fix the build issue in this project”. Figure 5 shows how GitHub Copilot helps to identify the build issue in the Gradle file and its reference libraries.

Code documentation

With Copilot, adding comprehensive documentation to your code becomes effortless. By writing a comment or a documentation block, Copilot can generate detailed Javadoc comments for methods and classes.

If you are working on code modernisation like Java upgrade or framework upgrade, you can use GitHub Copilot to accelerate the task easily. For example, I have a Struts 2 project and I tried to revamp the code (without altering functionality) to Springboot. I tried using the prompt “convert this project from struts to springboot 4.1.0 including fixing the dependencies in build.gradle”. Figure 6 explains how the response helps to modernise the code in a step-by-step guide.

We can also use Github Copilot for documentation and reverse engineering. For example, from a given code, I can prompt “create a component architecture diagram for this code” to generate a rough diagram like the one shown in Figure 7.

You can use this diagram to create markdown diagrams (like Mermaid JavaScript framework) and make visual diagrams in documentation like the GitHub wiki pages.

GitHub Copilot is a game-changer for developers, particularly when working on Enterprise Java applications. Its ability to assist in code development, correction, review, documentation, and testing significantly boosts productivity. By integrating Copilot into your development workflow, you can focus on solving complex problems instead of routine coding tasks. **END** 🐧

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